



Figure 4: The Package Manager has more to offer you

Of course, it'll also display the icons for removable devices when plugged in.

While we are on the subject of icons, Pardus uses something called the 'Tulliana' icon set by default, instead of the hideous-looking Crystal that comes with KDE3. I find Tulliana quite gorgeous.

The *Pardus* menu is a customised KDE menu, which only lists five options under the 'All Applications' category—*Tasma*, *Package Manager*, *Home*, *Find*, and the *Programs* menu. This *Programs* menu, in turn, lists the software section inside it, like *Games*, *Graphics*, *Internet*, etc, which otherwise show under 'All Applications' in KDE3, by default. I don't know how usable this customisation is, but it probably makes the lives of those used to the Winduws ways of doing things, a bit easier.

When it comes to applications, Pardus has everything covered for a typical desktop user—from multimedia and graphics apps to Internet and office tools. OpenOffice.org is still at v2.4.1—hope the next Pardus version carries v3.0 along with KDE4.

Anyway, this distro even includes all the multimedia apps like MP3, Flash, DivX, encrypted DVD decoder (*libdvdcss*), etc, by default. Makes the life of a new user easier, wouldn't you agree?

Something strange... in OpenOffice.org the English dictionaries are missing—so there's no spell check. I tried to look it up on the package manager, and had to install the *openoffice-dicts* package to get it working. This should have been installed by default.

It's also odd that the MPlayer UI is not translated to English. My cure is SMPlayer, because I anyway don't use the MPlayer UI.

Obviously, you can install more apps using the Pardus package manager—*what's it called again?*

PISI helps you get more stuff

PISI—Packages Installed Successfully, as Intended—is what they like to call the package manager. The command-line syntax is very similar to apt. So in order to install a package (e.g., kdesdk), you need to do the following:

pisi install kdesdk

To search for a package—e.g., Firefox:

[pisi search](#)
[firefox](#)

To remove a package—e.g., Firefox:

pisah remove firefox

To update the repository database:

```
pisi update-repo
```

There are many more options, so take a look at:

psi help

Of course, there's also a GUI front-end. You can access it either from the Pardus menu, or the icon sitting next to the clock. The package manager has an innovative UI. There're three tabs on top: *Show New Packages*, *Show Installed Packages*, and *Show Upgradable Packages*. Take a look at Figure 4; its UI is much better and easier to understand compared to the Adept manager that Kubuntu likes to bundle by default.

Let me spare you the torture

As for the final words, Pardus made me use KDE3 almost after a year—and I hate the fact of downgrading to something. That said, Pardus is a pretty solid distro, which will address the requirements of most desktop users, out of the box. If you want more, the package repository probably has the answer—although, don't expect the number of packages to be as high as any of the major distros.

I also found its hardware detection skills to be pretty good. Strange, that Pardus is ranked quite low in DistroWatch.com's hits-based rankings. On the downside, English support is missing in parts, and of course, there're some of these spelling mistakes in their custom applications. The greatest disadvantage is the absence of KDE4, by default. *Okay, okay, Time for me to buzz off.* **END** 

Pardus 2008.2

★★★★★

Pros: Boot speed, Tasma configuration manager, multimedia support, hardware support, impressive theme.

Cons: Absence of KDE4 by default, older version of OOo, spelling mistakes and missing translations

Platform: x86

Price: Free (as in beer)

Website: www.pardus.org.tr/eng

By: Atanu Datta

He likes to head bang and play air guitar in his spare time. Oh, and he's also a part of the LFY Bureau.